TCH → trastuzumab continuation

Default: six 21-day TCH cycles with IV trastuzumab, then trastuzumab alone to complete one year total. The source also permits weekly IV or fixed-dose SC trastuzumab alternatives; the team confirms the formulation and visit schedule.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Heart

Trastuzumab

Keep echo appointments; report breathlessness or swelling.

2 Hands / feet

Docetaxel

Report numbness or tingling before the next dose.

3 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy phase

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: call immediately.

4 Hair / scalp

Chemotherapy phase

Hair loss is common. Ask about scalp cooling before treatment where suitable.

5 Fluid / skin / nails

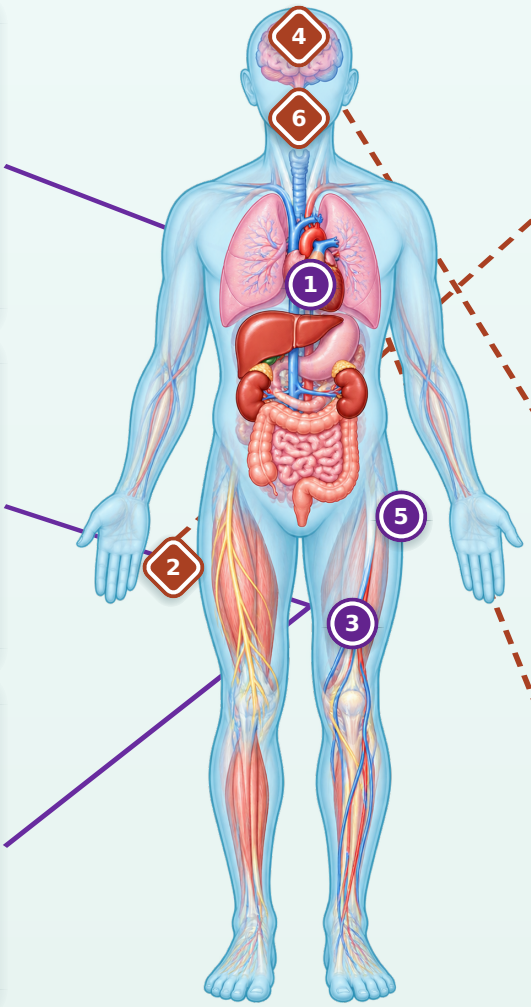
Docetaxel

Report swelling, painful skin or nail changes.

6 Mouth

Chemotherapy phase

Painful ulcers or difficulty drinking need advice.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Markers refer to the named active medicines. During HER2-only continuation, chemotherapy effects are not new expected effects of the antibodies; lingering chemotherapy effects still need review.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Docetaxel

- Low blood counts, infection and sepsis
- Hair loss, mouth soreness and fatigue
- Numbness / tingling; sometimes lasting
- Fluid retention and nail changes
- Allergic infusion reaction

Carboplatin

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Allergic reaction, sometimes after previous exposure
- Kidney or electrolyte changes

Trastuzumab

- Heart pumping-function reduction / heart failure
- Infusion or allergic reaction
- Diarrhoea and fatigue
- Rare serious lung effects

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

The correct phase prescription

Carboplatin AUC 6 uses the NCCP high-risk carboplatin row.

Premedicines and growth factors

Docetaxel dexamethasone is taken for three days starting the day before treatment. Ask the team to reconcile this with antiemetic steroids.

Tests and appointments

The team should name the booking owner, due window and person reviewing each required test. Tell them if an expected appointment has not arrived.

After chemotherapy

HER2-only continuation has its own minimal-emetic-risk plan; do not automatically continue chemotherapy steroids, antiemetics or growth factors.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00258/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.